Teenager Mika Stojsavljevic Claims First WTA Tour Win

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-11-04 5 min read

British teenager Mika Stojsavljevic beat former Australian Open champion Sofia Kenin to claim her first WTA Tour main-draw win despite learning only an hour before the match that she would be playing.

The 17-year-old had lost in **qualifying** for the Hong Kong Open, but entered the **main draw** as a "**lucky loser**," a player who gets a second chance when another player withdraws.

World number 411 Stojsavljevic then won a close deciding set against the American, taking the match 6-3, 4-6, 6-4.

"I only knew an hour before I was going to be playing. I kind of just went out and swung today," Stojsavljevic said. "I know she's a Grand Slam champion and it was never going to be an easy match, but I believed in myself and it worked out."

Kenin, 27, has had a difficult time since winning the Melbourne title in 2020, but she is still **ranked** 224 places above the young Briton a gap that makes the win even more impressive.

It is Stojsavljevic's second big win of the year. In April, she stunned then world number 56 Talia Gibson in Billie Jean King Cup **qualifying**.

Stojsavljevic started playing tennis aged seven at Ealing Lawn Tennis Club in north-west London, after watching her brother practise. In 2024, she became the first Briton in 15 years to win the US Open **junior** title, reached fifth in the **junior** world rankings, and turned professional in 2025.

Earlier this year, she reached the quarter-finals of a WTA 125 event in Birmingham, the tier just below the main Tour.

Next, Stojsavljevic will face world number 67 Zeynep Sonmez in the second round in Hong Kong with, one hopes, a little more than an hour's notice this time.

Word Treasure

lucky loser -- A player who lost in qualifying but still enters the main draw when another player withdraws.

qualifying -- Early matches players must win to earn a place in a tournament's main draw.

main draw -- The main part of a tournament, where the top players and qualifiers compete for the title.

ranked -- Placed on an official list that orders players by their recent results.

junior -- For young players; junior tournaments are for teenagers rather than adult professionals.

Background you need

In professional tennis, players usually enter a tournament through qualifying matches, but a 'lucky loser' who lost in qualifying can still reach the main draw if another player withdraws.

The WTA Tour is the top level of women's professional tennis, and player rankings order everyone by recent results, so a win over a much higher-ranked former champion is a major upset.

Grand Slam tournaments, like the Australian Open that Sofia Kenin won, are the sport's biggest events.

Break it down

LEAD: 17-year-old Mika Stojsavljevic beats a former Grand Slam champion for her first WTA Tour win

KEY EVENT: The Hong Kong Open match, won 6-3, 4-6, 6-4

+- WHO: Mika Stojsavljevic, world number 411, against former Australian Open champion Sofia Kenin

+- TWIST: She entered as a lucky loser and learned she was playing one hour before the match

BACKGROUND: 2024 US Open junior champion who turned professional in 2025

OPEN QUESTION: Her second-round match against world number 67 Zeynep Sonmez

Why it matters

A teenager beating a champion ranked 224 places above her shows how suddenly a young player can break through, and it gives other young athletes a story to aim at.

Test what you remember

1. How did Stojsavljevic get into the main draw?

(A) The champion invited her
(B) As a 'lucky loser' after another player withdrew
(C) By winning her qualifying matches
(D) By buying a special ticket

2. How long before the match did she learn she would be playing?

(A) One week
(B) One year
(C) One month
(D) One hour

3. What was the final score of the match?

(A) 7-6, 7-6
(B) 3-6, 6-4, 6-2
(C) 6-0, 6-0
(D) 6-3, 4-6, 6-4

4. Who did she beat?

(A) Zeynep Sonmez
(B) Talia Gibson
(C) Serena Williams
(D) Sofia Kenin

5. Sofia Kenin is a former champion of which event?

(A) The Hong Kong Open
(B) Wimbledon
(C) The US Open junior tournament
(D) The Australian Open

6. What did Stojsavljevic win in 2024?

(A) The Hong Kong Open
(B) An Olympic gold medal
(C) The US Open junior title
(D) The WTA Tour title

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: D 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Mika Stojsavljevic: Said she just went out and swung, believed in herself, and knew it was never going to be an easy match.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):